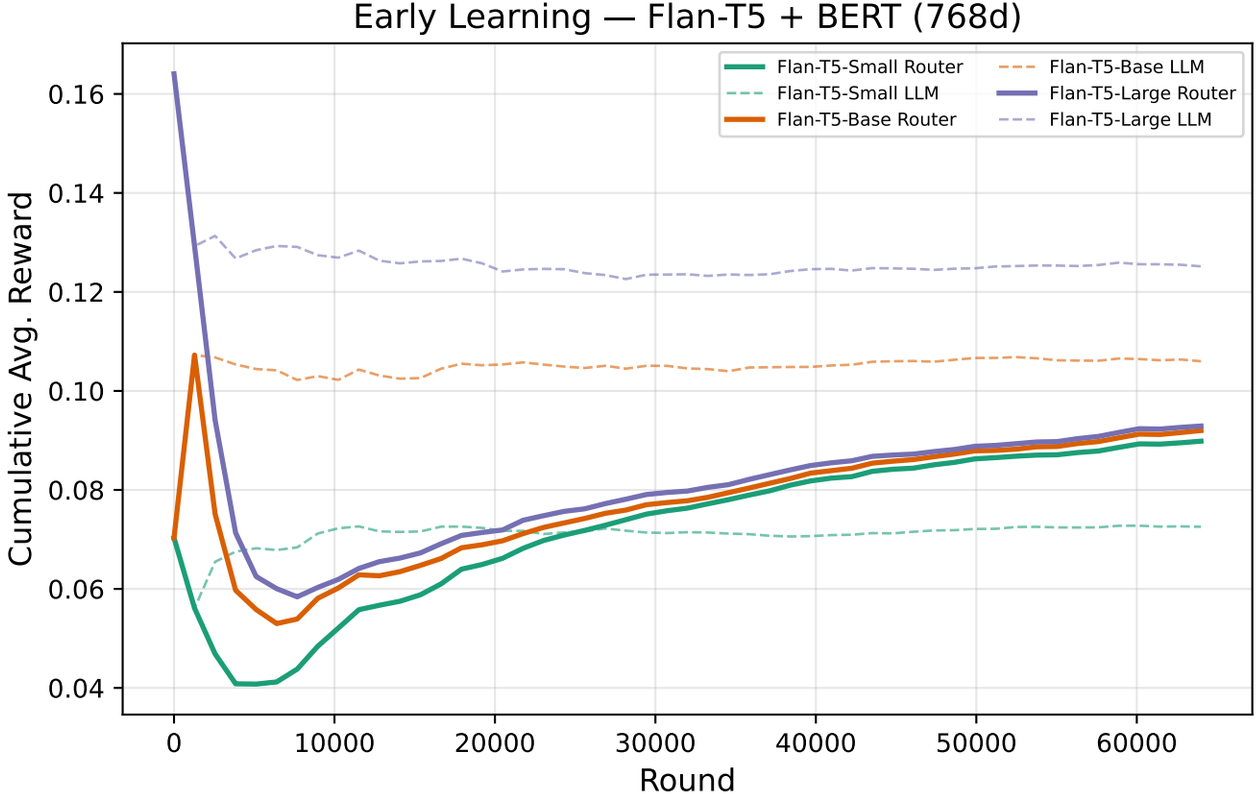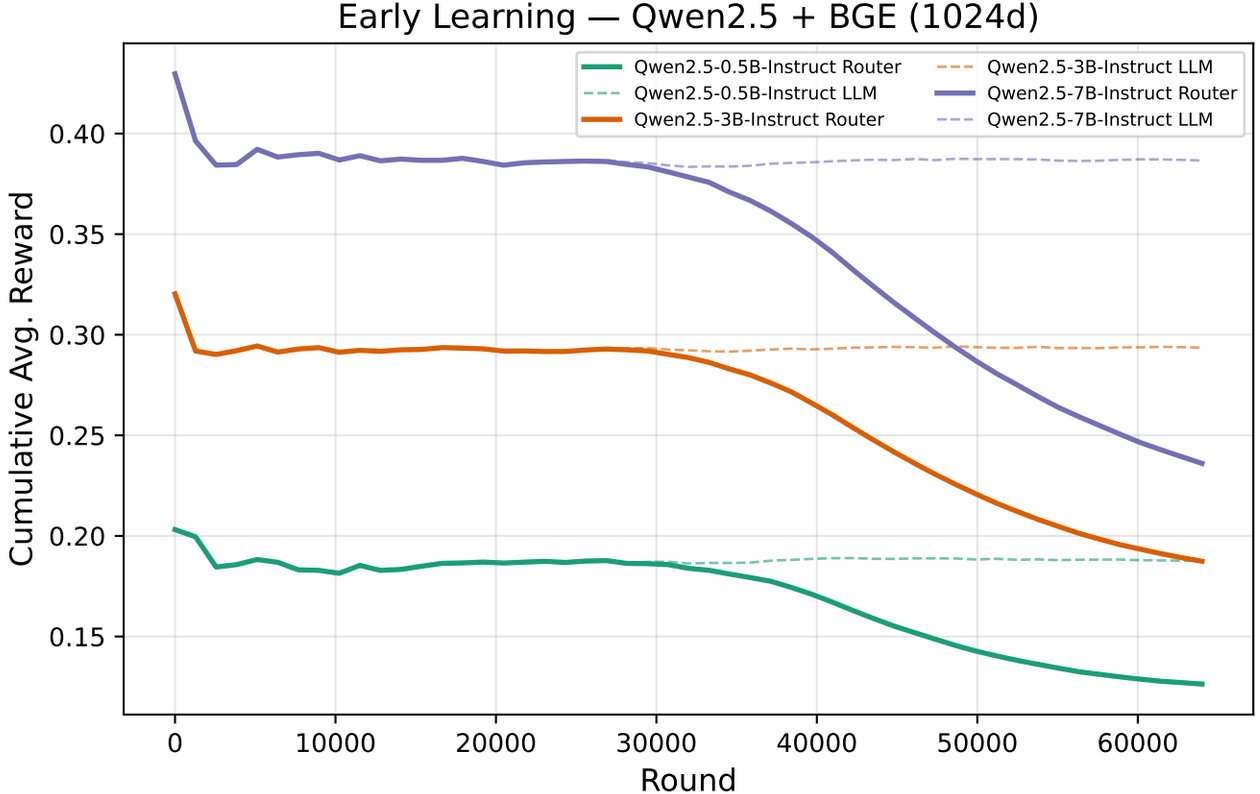Early-Phase Learning Dynamics (First 64K Rounds)